

LOFIBUDDHA



Breathwork Essentials

LofiBuddha — a guide for your practice



Four techniques to calm your nervous system

1. Box Breathing (4-4-4-4)

Used by Navy SEALs, first responders, and meditators. Activates the parasympathetic nervous system.

How to:

1. Inhale through your nose — 4 seconds
2. Hold your breath — 4 seconds
3. Exhale slowly through your mouth — 4 seconds
4. Hold empty — 4 seconds

Repeat 4-8 cycles. Best before stressful events, before sleep, or anytime you need to reset.

Why it works: The extended exhale activates the vagus nerve, signaling your body that it's safe. The counting occupies your mind's tendency to spiral.

2. 4-7-8 Breathing (The Relaxing Breath)

Dr. Andrew Weil calls this "a natural tranquilizer for the nervous system."

How to:

1. Exhale completely through your mouth, making a whoosh sound
2. Close your mouth. Inhale quietly through your nose — 4 seconds
3. Hold your breath — 7 seconds
4. Exhale through your mouth with a whoosh sound — 8 seconds

Repeat maximum 4 cycles. Do not exceed 4 cycles when first learning.

When to use: Falling asleep, during anxiety spikes, before meditation.

3. Diaphragmatic Breathing (Belly Breathing)

This is how you breathed as a baby. Most adults have unlearned it.

How to:

1. Lie on your back, knees bent. One hand on belly, one on chest.
2. Breathe so the belly hand rises while the chest hand stays still.
3. Breathe slowly: 3 seconds in, 3 seconds out.

4. Practice 5-10 minutes daily.

Why it matters: Chest breathing triggers fight-or-flight. Belly breathing signals safety. Retraining this pattern is the foundation of all breathwork.

4. Alternate Nostril Breathing (Nadi Shodhana)

An ancient yogic practice for balancing the nervous system.

How to:

1. Right thumb closes right nostril. Inhale through left nostril — 4 seconds.
2. Right ring finger closes left nostril. Release right nostril. Exhale right — 4 seconds.
3. Inhale right — 4 seconds.
4. Close right. Release left. Exhale left — 4 seconds.

This is one cycle. Repeat 5-10 cycles.

Best for: Before meditation, during transitions, when feeling scattered.

Practice Notes

- Never force the breath. If you feel lightheaded, return to natural breathing.
 - Consistency > duration. 5 minutes daily beats 30 minutes once a week.
 - Track your practice. Notice how you feel before and after.
-

LofiBuddha Breathwork Essentials — Part of the Mindful Path